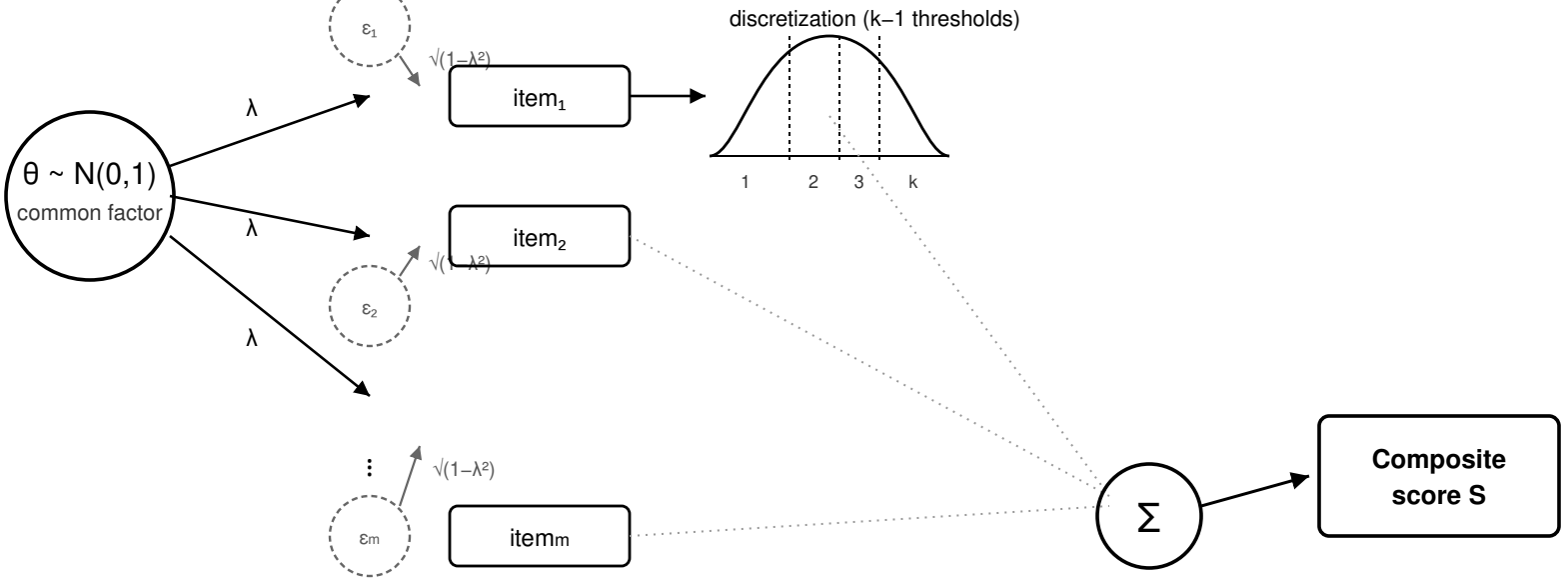
## A. Generative mechanism (one cell: one severity level × one value of k)




$item_j = \lambda \cdot \theta + \sqrt{(1-\lambda^2)} \cdot \varepsilon_j$ $threshold_j = p + \Sigma \exp(g_i)$ $\lambda = 1 / (1 + e^{-T})$

λ and the thresholds are calibrated JOINTLY (Nelder-Mead) to hit a (skewness, kurtosis) target — not only the thresholds, unlike the fixed-λ design

## B. Why a free λ matters: reachable (skewness, kurtosis) space

